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# TRIBAL COWBOY · The Pony Post

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## Dear Families,

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Today your child met **a pony, a horse, and Clydesdales**. They came to Hayden Canyon Charter all the way from a ranch in Athol, Idaho called Tribal Cowboy.

Here's what your child learned today:

### The 3 Big Rules for being safe around any horse:

1. **Inside voice**. Horses are prey animals — sudden loud noises sound like a predator coming to hunt them.
2. **Walk, don't run**. Quick movement scares horses. Calm body, calm horse.
3. **Tell the horse you're there**. Always say "Hi" before walking near her — especially behind her. Horses have two blind spots (in front of their nose and right behind their tail).

### How to read a horse's body:

- **Happy ears** point forward. **Grumpy ears** lie flat back.
- **Calm eyes** are soft and blinking. **Scared eyes** are wide with the white showing.
- **Quiet tail** hangs still. **Mad tail** swishes fast like a fly swatter.

### Three warning signs that mean STEP BACK and tell a grown-up:

1. Ears flat against her head
2. Tail swishing fast and hard
3. One back foot lifted off the ground

This is real horse-safety knowledge your child can carry around any animal — at the neighbor's farm, at a 4-H show, at the fair, anywhere — for the rest of their life.

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### Stacie Hines · Owner, Tribal Cowboy

I'm Stacie. I'm Nisenan Maidu, and I run Tribal Cowboy with my husband and our herd of ponies, horses, and Clydesdales in Athol, Idaho. We host birthday parties, pony rides, wagon rides, family events, and school programs across North Idaho and Eastern Washington.

If you'd ever like to bring your family out to the ranch, or book us for a birthday, school event, or community day — we'd love to hear from you.

**tribalcowboy.com** · [info@tribalcowboy.com](mailto:info@tribalcowboy.com) · (208) 261-2092

*Indigenous Owned · Athol, Idaho*

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# THE PONY POST — Coming to Schools Near You

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## What is The Pony Post?

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The Pony Post is a **4-week classroom reading program** built around real ponies, real letters, and real horse-safety skills. We bring a pony to your child's classroom once a week for four weeks. Between visits, **the pony mails the class real letters** with a hoof-print stamp on every envelope.

## Two age tracks:

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### Pre-K Track (ages 3–5)

- 25-minute classroom visits
- 20 new vocabulary words (horse body parts, colors, friendship, opposites)
- Letter recognition + rhyming + listening comprehension
- Real animal-safety knowledge
- A custom book — *The Pony Goes to School* — delivered by the pony at Visit 2 (every child gets their own copy to take home)

### K-2 Track (ages 5–8)

- 45-minute classroom visits
- 20 Dolch sight words aligned to Idaho ELA standards (K.RF.3, 1.RF.3, 2.RF.3)
- Syllable counting with a real pony's hoof (Idaho ELA K.RF.2.b / 1.RF.2)
- Reading fluency at Visit 3 — *kids read aloud to the pony* (the pony doesn't judge)
- The 3 Big Rules + Pony Looks + 3 Warning Signs (full body language curriculum)
- A custom book delivered by the pony at Visit 2

**Every Sprint ends with a Big Day** — either a field trip to the ranch in Athol or the Clydesdales visiting the school grounds.

### 100% Free to Your Child's School

The Pony Post is funded by community sponsors — local credit unions, family-owned businesses, and grants. **There is no cost to your school or to families.**

If you'd like to see The Pony Post come to your school next semester:

1. **Tell your child's teacher** you saw the program today and want to know more.
2. **Email us directly** at [info@tribalcowboy.com](mailto:info@tribalcowboy.com) — we'll send the school a one-page proposal.
3. **Ask your local credit union or family business if they'd sponsor a Sprint.** \$1,500 underwrites a Pre-K Sprint. \$2,000 underwrites a K-2 Sprint. The sponsor's logo goes on every book, certificate, and photo.

### Try Today's Lesson at Home

Ask your child:

- "What are the 3 Big Rules for being safe around a horse?"
- "What do happy ears look like? What about grumpy ears?"
- "Where are a horse's two blind spots?"

If they can answer those three questions, they have real horse-safety knowledge most adults don't have.

### **Want to Visit the Ranch?**

We host birthday parties with ponies (starting at \$300), family photo sessions with horses (instant photo delivery via QR code), school field trips, and community wagon rides.

info@tribalcowboy.com · (208) 261-2092 · tribalcowboy.com

*The Pony Post is an educational literacy and animal-safety program. It is not therapy or counseling. Activities are designed to support reading, vocabulary, and classroom calm.*

*Today's visit served ~325 students across 9 grade levels at Hayden Canyon Charter. Thank you, Hayden Canyon, for hosting us.  
— Stacie Hines · Tribal Cowboy*